

JAMM OS

Frontend Design Reference

Phase 12 — Implementation Guide for Claude Code

This document defines every visual decision for the JAMM OS frontend. It is the authoritative reference for Claude Code during implementation. Do not deviate from these specifications without updating this document first.

1. Visual Identity

JAMM OS uses a deep slate-blue color system derived from the JAMM Media brand. The design direction is modern and professional — clean enough to feel like a premium SaaS product, authoritative enough to inspire trust from accounting firm owners handling sensitive client data.

1.1 Color System — Light Mode

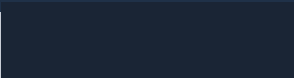
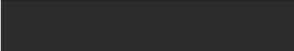
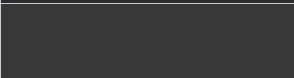
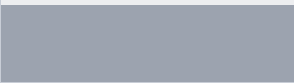
Light mode is the default for staff-facing interfaces. Background surfaces use cool light gray, not pure white, so there is visible depth between the page and card layers without borders.

Swatch	Token / Hex	Usage
	Sidebar	Primary sidebar background. Also used for primary buttons and primary text in light mode.
	Page background	Main content area background in light mode.
	Card / surface	Cards, panels, form inputs, and rows sit on this — slightly lighter than the page bg, creating lift without borders.
	Border / divider	Subtle borders on tables, modals, and form inputs.
	Primary text	Headings, client names, engagement titles, key labels. Brand blue doubles as primary text color.
	Body text	Paragraph content and row descriptions.
	Muted text	Secondary labels, timestamps, helper text, column headers.

Swatch	Token / Hex	Usage
	Placeholder	Empty input placeholder text and disabled states.

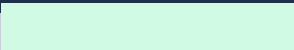
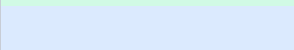
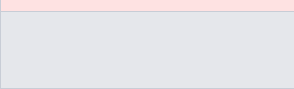
1.2 Color System — Dark Mode

Dark mode uses a medium-dark gray background similar to the Claude.ai interface — not pure black. The sidebar becomes slightly deeper to maintain contrast separation from the content area.

Swatch	Token / Hex	Usage
	Sidebar	Dark mode sidebar. Slightly deeper than content area for separation.
	Page background	Main content area in dark mode.
	Card / surface	Cards and panels in dark mode — lighter than page bg, same lift principle.
	Border / divider	Subtle dark borders in dark mode.
	Primary text	All primary text in dark mode. Same hex as light mode card surface — intentional echo.
	Muted text	Secondary and supporting text in dark mode.

1.3 Semantic / Status Colors

These colors are reserved for specific meanings throughout the app. Never use them decoratively. The same color system applies to both light and dark mode — only the badge background tints shift slightly in dark mode.

Color	Hex (bg / text)	Meaning
	Green	Complete, Paid, Done, Success
	Blue	In Progress, Sent, Active
	Amber	Awaiting Docs, Attention Needed, Warning
	Red	Overdue, Blocked, Error
	Gray + blue text	Not Started, Draft, Archived — use #1F3148 text + #1F3148 border

Green text: #065F46 on #D1FAE5. Blue text: #1E40AF on #DBEAFE. Amber text: #92400E on #FEF3C7. Red text: #991B1B on #FEE2E2. Gray text: #1F3148 (brand blue) on #E5E7EB with 0.5px solid #1F3148 border.

1.4 Interactive / Accent Colors

The slate-blue primary color serves as the sole action color. There is no separate accent color — the brand blue does everything. This keeps the system unified and avoids competing color signals.

State	Hex	Usage
	Primary button (light)	Default button background in light mode.
	Primary button (dark)	Lightened version of brand blue for dark mode buttons — same color family, readable on dark bg.
	Focus ring	Input focus state outline. 2px ring.
	Sidebar active item	Active/selected nav item indicator in sidebar.
	Active tab underline	Light mode tab active state border-bottom.

2. Typography

JAMM OS uses Inter as the primary typeface. Inter is a free, professionally-designed sans-serif built specifically for screen readability at small sizes — ideal for a data-dense practice management app. It is available via Google Fonts and is the default font for most shadcn/ui components.

Primary font: Inter (Google Fonts)
Fallback stack: Inter, -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, 'Segoe UI', sans-serif
Weights used: 400 (regular), 500 (medium) — never 600 or 700

2.1 Type Scale

Element	Size	Weight	Usage
Page title / H1	24px / 1.5rem	500	Section headings e.g. 'Clients', 'Engagements'
Card title / H2	16px / 1rem	500	Client names, engagement titles, modal headers
Body	14px / 0.875rem	400	Descriptions, form content, row details
Label / meta	12px / 0.75rem	500	Column headers, form labels, badge text
Caption / hint	11px / 0.6875rem	400	Helper text, timestamps, placeholder text

Never go below 11px. All column headers use uppercase with letter-spacing: 0.05em to distinguish them from content.

3. Tailwind CSS Configuration

Add the following to `tailwind.config.ts` to wire up the JAMM OS color system as named Tailwind classes. This allows using classes like `bg-surface`, `text-primary`, `border-subtle` throughout the codebase.

```
// tailwind.config.ts theme: { extend: { fontFamily: { sans: ['Inter', '-apple-system', 'BlinkMacSystemFont', 'Segoe UI', 'sans-serif'], }, colors: { brand: { DEFAULT: '#1F3148', light: '#4A7FA5', muted: '#7DA3C4', dark: '#1A2535', btn: '#3A6A94', }, surface: { page: '#E4E6EA', card: '#EDEEF0', border: '#C8CDD6', input: '#F7F7F8', }, dark: { page: '#2D2D2D', card: '#383838', border: '#484848', sidebar: '#1A2535', }, status: { green: '#D1FAE5', 'green-text': '#065F46', blue: '#DBEAFE', 'blue-text': '#1E40AF', amber: '#FFD700', 'amber-text': '#92400E', red: '#FEE2E2', 'red-text': '#991B1B', }, borderRadius: { badge: '9999px', card: '8px', modal: '10px', }, }, }
```

4. shadcn/ui Theme Settings

JAMM OS uses `shadcn/ui` as the component library. Override the CSS variables in `globals.css` to apply the JAMM OS color system to all `shadcn` components including Button, Input, Card, Dialog, Badge, and Toast.

```
/* globals.css */ :root { --background: 233 8% 90%; /* #E4E6EA */ --foreground: 215 23% 19%; /* #1F3148 */ --card: 220 8% 93%; /* #EDEEF0 */ --card-foreground: 215 23% 19%; /* #1F3148 */ --primary: 215 40% 19%; /* #1F3148 */ --primary-foreground: 220 8% 93%; /* #EDEEF0 */ --muted: 220 6% 80%; /* #C8CDD6 */ --muted-foreground: 220 9% 46%; /* #6B7280 */ --border: 218 14% 79%; /* #C8CDD6 */ --input: 220 8% 97%; /* #F7F7F8 */ --ring: 210 37% 47%; /* #4A7FA5 */ --radius: 0.5rem; } .dark { --background: 0 0% 18%; /* #2D2D2D */ --foreground: 220 8% 93%; /* #EDEEF0 */ --card: 0 0% 22%; /* #383838 */ --card-foreground: 220 8% 93%; /* #EDEEF0 */ --primary: 210 43% 40%; /* #3A6A94 */ --primary-foreground: 220 8% 93%; /* #EDEEF0 */ --muted: 0 0% 28%; /* #484848 */ --muted-foreground: 220 9% 62%; /* #9CA3AF */ --border: 0 0% 28%; /* #484848 */ --input: 0 0% 22%; /* #383838 */ --ring: 210 37% 47%; /* #4A7FA5 */ }
```

5. Layout and Navigation

5.1 Overall Structure

The app is divided into two permanent zones: a collapsible left sidebar and a main content area. The sidebar never disappears entirely — it collapses to icon-only mode (48px wide) when minimized, and expands to full label mode (220px wide) when open.

Sidebar expanded width: 220px

Sidebar collapsed width: 48px (icons only)

Content area: Fills remaining viewport width

Sidebar background: #1F3148 (light) / #1A2535 (dark)

Content background: #E4E6EA (light) / #2D2D2D (dark)

5.2 Sidebar Navigation Items

Fixed order. Settings is separated at the bottom. No customization in v1 — reordering is available in settings later.

- Dashboard — cross-client priority work view (default landing page)
- Clients — client list with search and view toggle
- Engagements — all engagements across all clients
- Tasks — all tasks across all clients and engagements
- Documents — firm-wide document library
- Billing — invoices and payment tracking
- Settings — pinned to bottom, separated by a divider

5.3 Drilling Into a Client — Pattern 1

Clicking a client from the Clients list navigates to a new page. The sidebar remains unchanged. The client name appears in a breadcrumb at the top of the content area. The client page uses tabs to navigate between sections.

Breadcrumb format: Clients / Acme Corp

Breadcrumb separator: / in muted gray #9CA3AF

Active crumb: #1F3148 bold, previous crumbs muted #6B7280

Tab order: Overview, Engagements, Documents, Billing

Active tab indicator: 2px border-bottom in #1F3148 (light) / #4A7FA5 (dark)

6. Core Components

6.1 Page Toolbar

Every list page (Clients, Engagements, Tasks, Documents) uses the same toolbar pattern at the top of the content area. It is always the first element below the page title or breadcrumb.

- Left: Search input — full-width flex, 36px height, magnifier icon, placeholder 'Search [entity]...'
- Middle: View toggle — card icon and list icon in a joined button group. Active icon has #1F3148 background with white icon. Inactive has surface background.
- Right: Primary action button — '+ New [entity]', #1F3148 background, white text, 6px border-radius

6.2 Data Tables

Used for Engagements, Tasks, Documents, and the row-view toggle of Clients. Style A — clean rows, no left stripe.

- Header row background: #EDEEF0 (light) / #252525 (dark)
- Header text: uppercase, 11px, letter-spacing 0.05em, color #6B7280
- Row background: #E4E6EA (light) / #2D2D2D (dark)
- Row divider: 0.5px solid #D5D8DE (light) / #383838 (dark)
- Row hover: background shifts 4% lighter — no border change
- Primary cell text: 12px, weight 500, color #1F3148 (light) / #EDEEF0 (dark)
- Secondary cell text: 12px, weight 400, color #374151 (light) / #9CA3AF (dark)
- All tables wrapped in a container with border-radius 10px, border 0.5px solid #C8CDD6, overflow hidden

6.3 Client Cards (Card View)

Used when the view toggle is set to card mode on the Clients page. Cards stack vertically in a single column on narrow viewports, 2-column grid on wide viewports.

- Background: #EDEEF0 (light) / #383838 (dark)
- Border-radius: 8px. No explicit border needed — card lifts off the page background by color difference alone.
- Padding: 12px 13px
- Top row: client name (12px, weight 500, #1F3148) left, engagement count (10px, #6B7280) right
- Second row: primary contact name, 11px, #6B7280
- Bottom row: status badge pills showing active engagement count and any awaiting-docs count

6.4 Forms

Used in modals and dedicated creation pages. Labels always sit above inputs, never beside them.

- Form container background: #EDEEF0 (light), 16px padding, 10px border-radius
- Label: 11px, weight 500, #1F3148. Required field indicator: 5px red dot (#E24B4A) to the right of the label text.
- Input background: #F7F7F8 (light) / #383838 (dark)
- Input border: 0.5px solid #C8CDD6 default, 0.5px solid #4A7FA5 on focus
- Input border-radius: 6px. Height: 36px for single-line, auto for textarea.
- Helper text: 11px, #6B7280, sits 4px below the input
- Two-column grid for short fields (name, industry). Full-width for email, notes, textarea.
- Action buttons: right-aligned. Cancel (ghost, #1F3148 border + text) then Save (#1F3148 bg, white text). Gap 8px.

6.5 Modals

Used for confirmations, quick-create flows, and destructive action gates. Always centered with a dimmed overlay.

- Overlay: rgba(0,0,0,0.35) covering full viewport
- Modal background: #EDEEF0 (light) / #383838 (dark)
- Border-radius: 10px. Border: 0.5px solid #C8CDD6.
- Header: 13px title weight 500 left, X close button right. Border-bottom 0.5px.
- Body: 12px body text, line-height 1.6, padding 14px 16px. Border-bottom 0.5px.
- Footer: right-aligned actions, padding 12px 16px. Cancel then confirm, gap 8px.
- Destructive confirms: confirm button uses #991B1B background (red), not brand blue.

6.6 Empty States

Every list page must have an empty state defined. Never show a blank content area.

- Container: centered vertically and horizontally in the content area
- Icon: 40x40px rounded box (#EDEEF0 bg, 0.5px border), SVG icon inside at 18px
- Heading: 13px, weight 500, #1F3148, margin-bottom 3px
- Subtext: 12px, #6B7280, one sentence describing the next step
- CTA button: '+ New [entity]', #1F3148 bg, white text, same style as toolbar primary button
- Vertical gap between elements: 10px

7. Client Portal

The client portal is a completely separate interface for the accounting firm's end clients. It shares the brand color system but uses a simplified layout with no sidebar. It is always dark mode by default, with a light mode toggle available in portal settings (not prominently surfaced).

7.1 Portal Structure

- No sidebar. Top bar only.
- Top bar background: #1F3148 always — same in both light and dark mode. This is the firm brand anchor.
- Top bar content: Firm name (12px, white, weight 500) left. 'Client Portal' label (10px, #7DA3C4) next to firm name. User avatar circle right.
- Tab row sits below the top bar. Maximum 3 tabs: To-do, Documents, Invoices.
- Active tab: 2px border-bottom in #4A7FA5 (dark mode) / #1F3148 (light mode)

7.2 Portal Color Tokens

Token	Dark mode (default)	Light mode
Top bar	#1F3148	#1F3148

Token	Dark mode (default)	Light mode
Tab row bg	#252525	#EDEEF0
Page background	#2D2D2D	#E4E6EA
Card background	#383838	#EDEEF0
Card border	#484848	none (lift by color)
Primary text	#EDEEF0	#1F3148
Muted text	#9CA3AF	#6B7280
Action button	#3A6A94 bg / #EDEEF0 text	#1F3148 bg / #FFFFFF text

7.3 Portal To-do Tab Layout

- Personal greeting: 'Hello, [First Name]' — 14px, weight 500. Subtext: 'You have N items that need your attention.' — 11px, muted.
- Section label 'Action needed': 10px uppercase, letter-spacing 0.05em, muted color. Margin-bottom 8px.
- Action cards: background #383838 (dark) / #EDEEF0 (light). Border-radius 8px. Padding 12px 14px. Flex row with item info left and action button right.
- Completed section: same card structure but 0.7 opacity. Appears below all active items.
- Section label 'Completed': same style as 'Action needed' label.

8. Status and Feedback Patterns

8.1 Status Badges

Pill-shaped badges used on engagement rows, task rows, invoice rows, and client cards. Consistent height across all contexts: 22px. Font: 11px, weight 500.

Status	Background	Text color	Border
In progress	#DBEAFE	#1E40AF	none
Awaiting docs	#FEF3C7	#92400E	none
Complete / Paid / Done	#D1FAE5	#065F46	none
Overdue / Blocked	#FEE2E2	#991B1B	none
Not started / Draft / Archived	#E5E7EB	#1F3148	0.5px solid #1F3148
Sent	#DBEAFE	#1E40AF	none

Gray badges only: add border 0.5px solid #1F3148 to give them definition. All other badge types have no border.

8.2 Toast Notifications

Toast notifications appear bottom-right of the viewport, stacking upward if multiple are active. Auto-dismiss after 4 seconds. Always include a manual close button.

- Container: background #EDEEF0 (light) / #383838 (dark). Border-radius 8px. Border 0.5px solid #C8CDD6. Border-left 3px solid [status color]. Min-width 300px, max-width 400px.
- Layout: colored dot (7px circle) left, text block center (flex-1), close X right.
- Title: 12px, weight 500, #1F3148 (light) / #EDEEF0 (dark).
- Body: 11px, #6B7280 (light) / #9CA3AF (dark).
- Success toasts: green left border (#10B981). No 'Why?' button.
- Error toasts: red left border (#E24B4A). Include 'Why?' link — underlined, 11px, weight 500, #1F3148.
- Warning toasts: amber left border (#F59E0B). Include 'Why?' link — same style as error.

'Why?' expandable detail panel:

- Appears below the main toast row when 'Why?' is clicked. Expanded inline — not a separate element.
- Error detail background: #FEE2E2. Border-top 0.5px solid #FECACA. Padding 9px 14px 9px 31px.
- Warning detail background: #FEF3C7. Border-top 0.5px solid #FDE68A. Same padding.
- Error detail text: 11px, #991B1B. List issues with centered dot prefix.
- Warning detail text: 11px, #92400E. Full sentence explaining context and suggested action.

8.3 Loading States — Skeleton Screens

All list pages and data tables use skeleton screens during loading, not spinners. The page structure renders immediately with placeholder shapes; content fills in as API responses arrive. This pattern makes the app feel faster.

- Skeleton background: #D5D8DE (light) / #444444 (dark)
- Skeleton border-radius: matches the element being replaced (4px for text rows, 20px for badge pills)
- Text skeletons: 8px tall, varying widths (40-80% of column) to simulate natural text variation
- Badge skeletons: 16px tall, 72px wide, border-radius 20px
- Row skeletons sit inside the same card surface as real rows — structure is identical to loaded state
- Never use full-page spinners. If a single component is loading within an otherwise loaded page, use a small inline spinner (16px) only within that component boundary.

9. Font Setup for Claude Code

Add Inter via Google Fonts in the Next.js app layout. Use the next/font/google package for optimal loading.

```
// app/layout.tsx import { Inter } from 'next/font/google' const inter = Inter({ subsets:
['latin'], weight: ['400', '500'], variable: '--font-inter', }) export default function
RootLayout({ children }) { return ( <html lang='en' className={inter.variable}> <body
className='font-sans bg-surface-page dark:bg-dark-page'> {children} </body>
</html> ) }
```

10. Quick Reference — Hex Codes

Token	Light mode	Dark mode	Both
Sidebar bg	#1F3148	#1A2535	
Page bg	#E4E6EA	#2D2D2D	
Card / surface bg	#EDEEF0	#383838	
Border / divider	#C8CDD6	#484848	
Primary text	#1F3148	#EDEEF0	
Body text	#374151	#9CA3AF	
Muted / label text	#6B7280	#9CA3AF	
Input bg	#F7F7F8	#383838	
Primary button bg	#1F3148	#3A6A94	
Button text	#FFFFFF	#EDEEF0	
Focus ring			#4A7FA5
Portal top bar			#1F3148
Success green			#10B981 / #D1FAE5
Error red			#E24B4A / #FEE2E2
Warning amber			#F59E0B / #FEF3C7
Active blue			#3B82F6 / #DBEAFE

Columns marked 'Both' apply identically in light and dark mode.

End of document.

JAMM OS

Notes, Client Messaging Badges, and Firm Chat — UI Specification

This appendix extends the Phase 12 Design Reference. All tokens, typography, and component patterns from the main document apply unless explicitly overridden below. Build these components only after the corresponding backend phases (11B, 11C, 11D, 11E) are complete.

11. Notes — Floating Panel

The Notes panel is a context-aware flyout attached to the right edge of the screen. It is always scoped to the entity currently being viewed — navigating to a different client, engagement, task, or document replaces the notes in the panel entirely. Notes are staff-only and are never exposed in the client portal.

11.1 Floating Tab — The Trigger

A narrow vertical tab sits fixed to the vertical center of the right edge of the viewport on all entity detail pages (Client detail, Engagement detail, Task detail, Document detail). It is hidden on Dashboard, list pages, Settings, and Billing list.

TAB ANATOMY

Property	Value	Notes
Width	36px	Narrow vertical strip
Height	80px	Fixed, centered vertically
Position	fixed, right: 0, top: 50%	Transform: translateY(-50%)
Background (light)	#1F3148	Brand blue — always visible against content
Background (dark)	#1A2535	Sidebar dark tone
Border-radius	8px 0 0 8px	Left corners rounded, flush to right edge
Icon	Pencil/note SVG, 16px	White icon, centered in tab
z-index	50	Above content, below modals

UNREAD BADGE — CONDITIONAL

- Badge is **hidden** when zero unread notes — clean icon only.
- Badge appears when unread count is 1 or more.
- 18px circle, background #E24B4A (red), white text, 11px weight 500.
- Position: top-left of the floating tab — top: -6px, left: -6px.
- Count exceeding 9 displays as "9+".
- Opening the panel marks all notes for that entity as read and clears the badge immediately.

11.2 Notes Panel — Flyout Drawer

Clicking the floating tab slides a panel in from the right edge (200ms ease-out). It overlays the content area — does not push or resize the page. A faint overlay covers the rest of the page; clicking it closes the panel.

PANEL STRUCTURE

Property	Value	Notes
Width	360px	Fixed width on desktop
Height	100vh	Full viewport height
Position	fixed, right: 0, top: 0	Slides in over content
Background (light)	#EDEEF0	Card surface token
Background (dark)	#383838	Dark card token
Border-left	0.5px solid #C8CDD6	#484848 in dark mode
Overlay behind panel	rgba(0,0,0,0.20)	Clicking overlay closes panel
z-index	40	Above content, below modals (z-index 50+)

PANEL HEADER

- Height: 48px. Border-bottom: 0.5px solid #C8CDD6 (light) / #484848 (dark).
- Left: note icon 14px + context label — e.g. "Notes — Acme Corp". 13px, weight 500.
- Right: X close button, 14px icon.

NOTES LIST

- Listed newest first, scrollable.
- Each note card: bg #E4E6EA (light) / #2D2D2D (dark), 6px radius, 10px 12px padding, 8px gap.
- Top row: author name (12px, weight 500) left. Timestamp (11px, #6B7280) right.
- Body: 13px, weight 400, #374151 light / #9CA3AF dark. Line-height 1.6.
- Private notes: lock icon beside author name. Card bg shifts to #FEF9EC (light) / #2D2A1E (dark).
- Delete icon on hover — staff see delete on own notes only; managers and firm_owner see delete on all.

EMPTY STATE

- Centered in panel. 32px icon in 40px rounded box.
- "No notes yet" heading: 13px, weight 500, #1F3148.
- "Add the first note below." subtext: 12px, #6B7280.

11.3 Compose Box

Pinned to the bottom of the notes panel, always visible.

- Textarea: bg #F7F7F8 (light) / #2D2D2D (dark), 0.5px border (focus: #4A7FA5), 6px radius, min-height 72px.
- Placeholder: "Add a note..." — 13px, #9CA3AF.
- Below textarea: private toggle left, Add Note button right.
- Private toggle: checkbox + "Private note" label, 11px, #6B7280. Default unchecked (shared).
- Add Note button: #1F3148 bg, white text, 12px weight 500, 6px radius, 32px height. Disabled until textarea has content.
- On submit: note appears at top of list (optimistic UI), textarea clears.

12. Unread Badge — Client Messages

Defines the unread badge behavior for the Messages tab on the Client detail page (staff side) and the Messages tab in the Client Portal. Badge logic is identical in both contexts — only the visual tokens differ.

12.1 Staff Side — Client Detail Page

The Messages tab sits in the Client detail tab row alongside Overview, Engagements, Documents, and Billing. The tab label gains an unread count badge when the client has sent messages that the current staff member has not yet read.

BADGE SPECIFICATION

Property	Value	Notes
Position	Inline, right of "Messages" label	Gap 6px between label and badge
Shape	Pill — border-radius 9999px	Width auto, height 18px, min-width 18px
Background	#1F3148 (brand blue)	Consistent with brand primary
Text color	#FFFFFF	11px, weight 500. Padding: 0 6px
Hidden when	Unread count = 0	Tab label shows as plain text, no empty badge
Shows when	Unread count ≥ 1	Count > 99 displays as "99+"
Clears when	Messages tab opened	Also does not badge if tab already active

12.2 Portal Side — Client Portal Messages Tab

Same badge logic from the client's perspective — badge appears when the firm has sent a message the client has not yet read.

- Background: #4A7FA5 (brand light). Dark mode: #3A6A94. Text: #EDEEF0.
- Portal tab row is now four tabs: To-do / Documents / Invoices / Messages. Messages is rightmost.
- Badge hidden when zero, appears at 1+, clears on tab open — same logic as staff side.

13. Firm Chat — Internal Team Communication

An internal messaging system for firm staff only. Completely separate from client-facing messaging — clients have no visibility. Lives as a dedicated sidebar navigation item between Billing and Settings. Supports multiple firm-owner-created channels, text, file attachments, and @mentions.

13.1 Sidebar Navigation Item

PLACEMENT AND BADGE

- Added between Billing and Settings. Updated nav order: Dashboard / Clients / Engagements / Tasks / Documents / Billing / **Firm Chat** / [divider] / Settings.
- Icon: speech bubble SVG, 18px. Label: "Firm Chat".
- Unread badge (expanded sidebar): pill badge right of label, same spec as Section 12.1.
- Unread badge (collapsed sidebar): 18px circle, top-right of icon.
- Badge counts total unreads across all channels. Clears per-channel as user opens and reads each.

13.2 Firm Chat Page Layout

Two-column layout inside the content area when navigating to Firm Chat. Sidebar unchanged.

Zone	Width	Contents
Channel list	220px	List of firm channels with unread indicators
Message feed	Remaining width	Active channel messages + compose box

CHANNEL LIST PANEL

- Background (light): #E4E6EA. Background (dark): #2D2D2D.
- Border-right: 0.5px solid #C8CDD6 (light) / #484848 (dark).
- "Firm Chat" heading: 13px weight 500 #1F3148, padding 16px 14px 8px.
- Below heading: "+ New Channel" — 11px weight 500 #4A7FA5, left-aligned, no bg. firm_owner only.
- Channel rows: 36px height, 0 14px padding, 6px radius. Hover: #D5D8DE (light) / #383838 (dark).
- Active channel: bg #1F3148 (light) / #1A2535 (dark), white text.
- Channel name: "# channel-name" 13px weight 400.
- Unread indicator: 6px filled circle #4A7FA5 right of channel name. Disappears when read.

13.3 Message Feed

Chronological order, oldest at top, newest at bottom. Auto-scrolls to bottom on new messages unless user has scrolled up (show "New messages ↓" button at bottom edge).

MESSAGE ITEM ANATOMY

- Avatar: 28px circle, initials. Background: brand blue family (#1F3148, #3A6A94, #4A7FA5, #7DA3C4) cycling by user index.
- Name (12px weight 500 #1F3148) + timestamp (11px #6B7280), gap 8px.
- Body: 13px weight 400 #374151 (light) / #9CA3AF (dark). Line-height 1.6. Margin-left 40px.
- Consecutive messages same sender within 5min: suppress avatar + name repeat. Body only, indented 40px.
- Date dividers: centered label "Today" / "Yesterday" / "Mar 14" — 11px #6B7280, horizontal lines either side.

@MENTIONS

- Typing @ opens popover above compose: bg #EDEEF0/#383838, 8px radius, max-height 200px, scrollable. Staff rows: 20px avatar + name.
- @mention chip in message: bg #DBEAFF, text #1E40AF, 4px radius, 0 4px padding. Same in both modes.
- Mentioned user receives in-app notification even if not watching the channel.

FILE ATTACHMENTS

- Paperclip icon in compose row, 16px, #6B7280. Accepted: pdf, jpg, png, xlsx, csv, docx. Max 25MB.
- Preview chip in compose before send: file icon + name + size + X. #EDEEF0 bg, 0.5px border, 6px radius.
- Sent attachment in feed: same chip style + download icon right. Click generates signed S3 URL (1hr expiry, never public).

13.4 Compose Box

Pinned to the bottom of the message feed, always visible.

- Border-top: 0.5px solid #C8CDD6 (light) / #484848 (dark). Padding: 12px 16px.
- Input: bg #F7F7F8 (light) / #2D2D2D (dark), 0.5px border (focus: #4A7FA5), 8px radius. Min-height 40px, max-height 160px (auto-grows).
- Placeholder: "Message # channel-name..." — updates to match active channel. 13px, #9CA3AF.
- Send button: #1F3148 bg, white text, 12px weight 500, 6px radius, 32px height. Disabled until content.
- Enter to send. Shift+Enter inserts new line without sending.

13.5 Channel Management — Firm Owner Only

- Only firm_owner can create, rename, or delete channels. All staff can view and post.
- Create channel modal: single field "Channel name", lowercase enforced, spaces → hyphens. Cancel + Create buttons right-aligned.
- Hovering a channel row reveals "... " icon. Dropdown: Rename / Delete.
- Delete confirmation modal: confirm button uses #991B1B red background (destructive pattern from Section 6.5).

13.6 Empty States

NO CHANNELS YET

- Centered speech-bubble icon in 40px rounded box.
- "No channels yet" heading: 13px weight 500 #1F3148.
- "Create your first channel to start the conversation." — 12px #6B7280.
- "+ New Channel" CTA (firm_owner only). Staff see subtext only, no CTA.

CHANNEL EXISTS, NO MESSAGES YET

- "No messages in # channel-name yet." centered, 12px #6B7280.
- "Be the first to post something." subtext below.

14. Updated Sidebar Navigation Order

The addition of Firm Chat updates Section 5.2 of the main design reference. Updated fixed order:

- Dashboard
- Clients
- Engagements
- Tasks
- Documents
- Billing
- **Firm Chat** ← new item (speech bubble icon, unread badge)
- [divider]*
- Settings (pinned bottom, unchanged)

The sidebar unread badge on Firm Chat follows the same logic as all notification surfaces: badge appears when unread messages exist in any channel, clears per-channel as the user reads them.

15. Backend Dependency Map

Every UI component in this appendix depends on a backend phase being complete first.

UI Component	Backend Phase	Key Endpoints	Frontend Session
Notes floating panel	Phase 11B — Notes System	GET /notes, POST /notes, PATCH /notes/{id}, DELETE /notes/{id}	Session 10 (12F-6)
Client messaging (staff + portal)	Phase 11C — Messaging	GET /messages, POST /messages, GET /portal/messages, POST /portal/messages	Session 10 (12F-7, 12F-8)

UI Component	Backend Phase	Key Endpoints	Frontend Session
Portal preview (staff)	Phase 11D — Portal Preview	GET /portal/preview/{client_id}	Session 11 (12F-9)
Firm Chat	Phase 11E — Firm Chat (new)	GET /firm-chat/channels, GET /firm-chat/channels/{id}/messages, POST /firm-chat/channels/{id}/messages	Session 12 (12H)

Phase 11E — Firm Chat Backend (New Phase):

Firm Chat requires a new backend phase not previously on the roadmap. Models needed: Channel (id, firm_id, name, created_by, created_at), FirmMessage (id, firm_id, channel_id, sender_id, body, attachment_key nullable, mentions JSON array, created_at), FirmMessageRead (id, firm_message_id, user_id, read_at). Build Phase 11E before the Firm Chat frontend session (12H).